10 Role of Different Stakeholders in Indian National Movement

The Indian freedom struggle relied on diverse stakeholders, with women playing a crucial yet often overlooked role. When male leaders were imprisoned, women bravely assumed leadership, ensuring the movement's continuity. Despite facing exploitation and hardship, they actively participated in the anti-imperialist movement, demonstrating remarkable courage. Their sacrifices were integral to India's quest for liberation, highlighting the indispensable role of women in shaping history.

Role Played by Women in the National Movement

Role of Women Before the Gandhian Phase

- **Early Phase:**
  - British colonel **Malcolm** was defeated in guerilla warfare by **Bhima Bai Holkar**. She led the war against the British in 1817.
  - Many women, including **Rani Chennamma of Kittur and Rani Begam Hazrat Mahal** of Avadh, fought against the British East India Company in the 19th century, much before the 1857 revolt.
  - **Maharani Velu Nachiyar** (1730–1796) bravely fought against the British army and defeated them decisively.
  - **Gauri Parvati Bai**, the queen of Travancore put a focus on the importance of girls' education which helped women to overcome social and academic stigma.
- **First War of Independence (1857-58):**
  - In the War of Independence (the Great Revolt) of 1857, women played a commendable role.
  - **Chauhan Rani, Tapasvini Maharani, Rani of Ramgarh, Rani Jindan Kaur, Rani Tace Bai, Baiza Bai, and Rani Tace** led their armies into battle with courage.
  - **Rani Lakshmi Bai** of Jhansi set a remarkable example of true patriotism through her bravery and outstanding leadership.
- **Swadeshi Movement:** Women were encouraged to weave clothes, discouraged from using imported goods, and took part in picketing campaigns to force liquor stores to close.

Role of Women During Gandhian Phase

- **Participation in the Non-Cooperation Movement (1920s):** Women engaged in nationalist activities while maintaining domestic values and navigated the growing political consciousness within households influenced by male family members.
- **Role in Civil Disobedience & Salt March (1930s):** Women joined rallies, prabhat pheris, and protests; led civil disobedience after male leaders' arrests; and engaged in constructive Gandhian work like spinning and fasting.
- **Leadership in Salt Satyagraha:** Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay and Sarojini Naidu played key roles. Naidu led the Dharsana protest. Leaders like Durgabai mobilized large groups, and many, including Muhtulakshmi Reddy and Margaret Cousins, faced imprisonment.
- **Contribution during Quit India Movement (1942):** With top male leaders detained, women sustained the movement through marches, hartals, and underground activities. Sucheta Kripalani led satyagraha and was jailed for two years.

Women's Contribution during Freedom Movements

- **Social and Women Mobilisation:** Women leaders like Kasturba Gandhi, and Savitri Bai Phule, came forward to alter the social fabric
- **Revolutionary Movements:** Indian women also participated in revolutionary movements against British rules, such as - **Kalapana Datta** participated in the raid on the Chittagong armoury.
  - **Rani Gaidineliu,** also popularly known as "**Queen of Naga**" was the leader of the Naga nationalist movement against the British.
  - **Pritilata Waddekar** led the **fifteen revolutionaries in the 1932** armed attack on the Pahartali European Club
- **Raising voice of freedom at International platform: Bhikaji Cama** founded the Free India Society in the United Kingdom and was referred to as Mother India's first cultural representative in the United States.
  - **Vijay Laxmi Pandit** spoke up for India at the UN meeting in San Francisco.

- **Establishment of Social institutions**: District Congress Committees and independent female organisations like Rashtriya Stree Sanghas were combined. Additionally, widows, scheduled/marginalised sections, Hindu/Muslim, and Muslim women were all included.

Barriers to Women's Involvement in the Freedom Struggle

- **Absence of Leadership Roles:** Women were largely absent from leadership positions within the nationalist movement, often providing support to male leaders and implementing plans formulated by organizations like the INC.
  - **Example:** Despite their significant contributions, figures like Pritilata Waddedar and Kalpana Dutt often operated under the leadership of male figures such as Surya Sen, highlighting the limited leadership roles available to women.
- **Lack of Scientific Education:** Limited access to Western education among upper-middle-class women hindered the development of contemporary, secular, liberal, and scientific perspectives.
- **Influence of Patriarchal Society:** The dominance of patriarchy redirected opportunities towards men, impeding women's advancement in nation-building efforts. Additionally, societal expectations confined women to domestic roles.

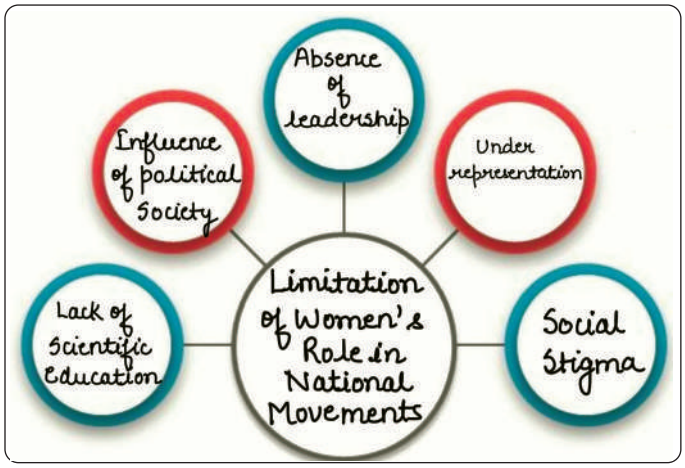

Fig. 10.1: Barriers to Women's Involvement in the Freedom Struggle
Diagram Type: *Hub & Spoke*

- **Social Stigma:** Women were often perceived as weak and incapable of withstanding the British authorities' harsh repression, contributing to their limited participation in resistance activities.
- **Underrepresentation:** Women were marginalized in prominent institutions such as Congress and labor unions, with few opportunities for leadership roles.
  - **Example:** Limited representation in Congress membership and labor union organizations.

Role of Gandhi ji in Promoting Women's Contribution in National Movement

- *"A yagna is incomplete without women taking part in it"* — ***Gandhi Ji during NCM***
- From **Lakshmibai to Bhima Holkar**, women displayed unflinching courage during India's pre-Gandhian freedom struggle.
- Later, women turned into the ideal representation of morality and motherhood. But there was a significant shift in women's participation in the nationalist movement after the arrival of Gandhiji.
- **Women's Role with Gandhi Ji:**
  - **Opposed social evils:** He opposed social evils like the purdah system, child marriage and promoted education.
  - **Increased active participation:** More women participated because of Gandhi's insistence on non-violence and his emphasis on upholding the dignity of women satyagrahis.
  - **Non-Cooperation Movement**: During the NCM, many women were sentenced to prison for the first time.
  - **Civil Disobedience Movement:** Dharasana Salt Satyagraha was led by Sarojini Naidu. Kamla Devi addressed meetings and prepared salt. **Nari Satyagraha Committee** was established.
  - **Quit India Movement**: When Gandhi said, "Do or die", Usha Mehta persisted in broadcasting until their arrest.

Sarojini Naidu and her Role in Freedom Movement

- **During Bengal Division**: She joined the national movement during the 1905 protest against the division of Bengal.
- **Role as INC member**: Sarojini Naidu started to become famous as a nationalist in 1917. She was appointed INC's second female president in 1925.
- **Social Service:** She received the Kaiser-i-Hind award from the British government for her services during the Indian plague epidemic, and she served as president of the East African Indian Congress in South Africa.
- **Raised voice for women's Rights**: She participated extensively in the creation of the Women's Indian Association and travelled to London with a delegation promoting women's voting rights.
- **Salt Satyagraha:** She was a leader in the civil disobedience movement and one of the female protesters at the Dharasana salt plant during the salt satyagraha.
- **Quit India Movement:** She was held in detention in 1942 during the Quit India campaign.

Women's and Revolutionary Activities

- **Pritilata Waddedar:** She was a revolutionary nationalist and joined a group headed by Surya Sen. She is known for leading **fifteen revolutionaries in the 1932 armed attack** on the Pahartali European Club. The revolutionaries torched the club and were later caught by the British police.
- **Kalpana Dutta:** She joined the Indian Republican Army. She along with Pritilata Waddedar in 1931 attacked the European club in Chittagong. Later she was booked under the **Chittagong Armoury Raid** case and was sentenced to life imprisonment.

Women's contributions to the Indian freedom struggle were crucial and cannot be measured or quantified. They ranged from being ordinary people to leading the mass movement. Author **Katherine Mayo** criticised Hindu men and the treatment of women as property within the family in her book **Mother India**. Nationalists and reformers were forced to concentrate on families and establish a nonviolent home environment.

Women Leaders Who Contributed to Framing of Constitution of India

Women Leaders	Details
Sarojini Naidu (1879-1949)	❖ Sarojini Naidu was a renowned poet, feminist, and political activist who ardently championed **women's emancipation, anti-imperialism, and civil rights.** ❖ Notably, she achieved the historic feat of becoming the first Indian woman to be elected as the President of the Indian National Congress. ❖ Her significant contributions extended to India's independence struggle, and she immortalized her ideals through her acclaimed anthology **"In The Bazaars of Hyderabad,"** published in 1912.
Dakshayani Velayudhan (1912-1978)	❖ Born in 1912, Dakshayani Velayudhan hailed from the Pulayar community and emerged as a prominent advocate for **decentralization of the constitution draft.** ❖ She vehemently advocated for the implementation of non-discriminatory provisions and vociferously **condemned caste discrimination.** ❖ Velayudhan emphasized that the effectiveness of the Constitution relied on the future conduct of the people rather than merely its legal execution.
Begum Aizaz Rasul (1909-2001)	❖ As the only Muslim woman in the Constituent Assembly of India, Begum Aizaz Rasul played a pivotal role in shaping the nation's foundational document. ❖ Her commitment to social welfare and minority rights was further exemplified during her tenure as Minister of Social Welfare and Minorities from 1969 to 1971. ❖ In recognition of her remarkable contributions, she was honored with the prestigious **Padma Bhushan award in 2000.**
Hansa Jivraj Mehta (1897-1995)	❖ Hansa Jivraj Mehta, a multifaceted personality, was a fervent feminist, social activist, reformist, and educator. She actively participated in drafting fundamental rights and tirelessly advocated for gender equality, leaving an indelible mark on India's constitutional framework. ❖ Notably, Mehta was instrumental in revising the language of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, underscoring the imperative of gender parity.
Leela Roy (1900-1970)	❖ Leela Roy, a radical leftist politician and dedicated social worker, spearheaded numerous initiatives aimed at advancing women's rights and education. ❖ Her pioneering efforts included the establishment of "**Jayasree**," India's inaugural magazine managed entirely by women, in 1931. ❖ Roy's advocacy encompassed not only **educational empowerment** for girls but also the promotion of **vocational training,** reflecting her holistic approach towards societal upliftment.
Durgabai Deshmukh (1909-1981)	❖ Durgabai Deshmukh, revered for her unwavering commitment to Gandhian principles, made significant strides in the realms of women's education and social welfare. ❖ In addition to her pivotal role in the Constituent Assembly, Deshmukh's tenure as the chairperson of the National Council on Women's Education underscored her dedication to fostering gender inclusivity in educational spheres. ❖ Her legacy endures as a testament to her tireless endeavors towards realizing Mahatma Gandhi's vision of a just and equitable society.
Ammu Swaminathan (1894-1978)	❖ Ammu Swaminathan, a stalwart political activist and social worker, overcame myriad challenges to emerge as a beacon of resilience and empowerment. ❖ Despite facing early marriage at the age of thirteen, Swaminathan embarked on a journey of self-education under her husband's guidance, mastering various subjects, notably English. ❖ Her unwavering dedication to social causes earned her the esteemed title of **'Mother of the Year'** during the inauguration of International Women's Year in 1975, symbolizing her enduring impact on society.

Renuka Ray (1904-1997)	❖ Renuka Ray's distinguished tenure as a member of the All India Women's Conference and her subsequent receipt of the **Padma Bhushan in 1988** underscore her profound contributions to Indian society. ❖ Her pivotal role in shaping social welfare policies, notably through her leadership of the **committee on Social Welfare and Welfare of Backward Classes in 1959,** reflects her unwavering commitment to societal progress. ❖ Through her seminal work**, "My Reminiscences: Social Development During the Gandhian Era and After,"** Ray provided invaluable insights into the socio-political landscape of India during pivotal historical epochs.
Kamla Chaudhry (1908-1970)	❖ Kamla Chaudhry, a formidable figure in India's freedom struggle, exemplified unwavering resolve and dedication towards the nation's independence. ❖ Her active participation in the Constituent Assembly and subsequent appointment to the Provincial Government underscore her significant contributions to nation-building efforts post-independence. ❖ Chaudhry's indelible legacy serves as a poignant reminder of the pivotal role played by women in shaping India's democratic fabric and socio-political landscape.
Purnima Banerjee (1911-1951)	❖ Purnima Banerjee's brief yet impactful tenure in the Constituent Assembly between 1946 and 1950 exemplifies her unwavering commitment to grassroots activism and rural development. Her concerted efforts to uplift marginalized communities, particularly farmers and rural inhabitants, reflect her deep-rooted empathy and dedication towards societal betterment. ❖ Banerjee's enduring legacy continues to inspire future generations to actively engage in grassroots activism and effect positive change within their communities.
Rajkumari Amrit Kaur (1887-1964)	❖ Rajkumari Amrit Kaur's illustrious career spanned various domains, from her active involvement in the Indian Independence Movement to her stewardship of ministerial portfolios. Her unwavering advocacy for a **Uniform Civil Code** and staunch support for religious rights and universal franchise underscore her commitment to fostering inclusivity and social justice. ❖ Kaur's enduring legacy serves as a testament to her indomitable spirit and tireless efforts towards realizing the ideals of a pluralistic and egalitarian society.
Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit (1900-1990)	❖ Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit's trailblazing tenure as **India's ambassador to the Soviet Union** from 1947 to 1949 underscores her pivotal role in shaping India's foreign policy and diplomatic relations. ❖ As the first woman to hold a cabinet position in the pre-independence era, Pandit shattered gender barriers and paved the way for future generations of women leaders. ❖ Her diplomatic acumen and unwavering commitment to national interests continue to inspire aspiring diplomats and policymakers across the globe.
Annie Mascarene (1902-1963)	❖ Annie Mascarene's groundbreaking achievements as a lawyer and Member of Parliament underscore her trailblazing journey towards gender parity and political representation. Her pivotal role in the drafting of the **Hindu Code Bill** during the Constitution's formulation reflects her unwavering commitment to advancing legal reforms and women's rights. ❖ Mascarene's enduring legacy serves as a poignant reminder of the transformative power of women's leadership in effecting positive change within legislative frameworks.
Sucheta Kriplani (1908-1974)	❖ Sucheta Kriplani's poignant rendition of "Vande Mataram" during the Independence Session of the Constituent Assembly epitomizes her unwavering patriotism and commitment to India's freedom struggle. ❖ Her seminal role in founding the All India Mahila Congress in 1949 underscores her dedication to championing women's rights and political empowerment. ❖ Kriplani's indomitable spirit and leadership continue to inspire generations of women to actively participate in democratic processes and effect transformative change.
Malati Choudhury (1904-1998)	❖ Malati Choudhury's pioneering contributions as one of the fifteen founding mothers of the Indian Constitution underscore her enduring commitment to grassroots activism and social reform. Despite ideological differences with fellow members, Choudhury emphasized the pivotal role of education, particularly for adults and rural communities, in fostering societal progress. ❖ Choudhury's legacy serves as a poignant reminder of the transformative power of grassroots activism and the enduring importance of education in driving societal change.

Role of Capitalist Class in Freedom Struggle

- **Emergence of Indian Capitalism:** Indian capitalism such as Tata steel company, V.O. Chidambaran Pillai ship Navigation Company etc. grew due to wartime import substitution and shifting global trade patterns.
- **Early Industrialist Stance:** Despite nationalist support for Indian industries, early capitalists did not actively back the freedom movement due to their limited power and reliance on colonial structures.
- **Swadeshi and Non-Cooperation Movements:** Most capitalists opposed the Swadeshi boycott (1905–08). A few, like G.D. Birla and Purushottam Das, supported the Non-Cooperation Movement but remained cautious overall.
- **Civil Disobedience Movement:** Capitalists showed greater support during this phase, but their limited participation failed to significantly boost the movement.
- **Opposition to Violent Revolution:** Industrialists opposed radical or violent methods fearing the rise of socialism, which threatened their economic interests.

Reasons to support the movement

- **Strengthening of Indian Rupees:** On the **Hilton Young Commission's** advice, the Indian rupee was strengthened against the British pound in 1926. This was not conducive to the export of goods.
- **Exemption of British goods from import duty:** To protect Indian industries after the 1929–30 economic downturn, the import duty was increased from 5% to 11%, but British goods got more preference and were exempted from this hike in duty.

Contribution of Industrialists during National Movement

- **Institution Building for National Interest:** Industrialists like G.D. Birla and Purshottamdas Thakurdas promoted national-level economic organisations to counter European dominance, leading to the creation of FICCI in 1927.
- **Financial Support to the Freedom Movement:** Some industrialists, such as Chidambaram Pillai, provided funds to support the Indian National Congress and its regional branches.
- **Promotion of Swadeshi Enterprises:** In response to the boycott of foreign goods, capitalists set up Swadeshi industries like textile mills, tanneries, soap and match factories, banks, and insurance firms.
- **Preference for Constitutional Methods:** Industrialists avoided mass civil disobedience due to fears of social unrest and disruption to business, instead supporting constitutional and moderate forms of resistance.

Labour and Communist Class in Freedom Struggle

- The Russian Revolution of 1917 inspired Indian revolutionary nationalists and moved them towards socialism.
- The failure of the non-cooperation movement further convinced them that Independence could not be acquired solely through Non-cooperation.
- After the First World War, the Indian working class remained steadfast defenders of democratic freedoms until August 1947.
- A conducive atmosphere for developing socialist ideas was provided during the course of the War. People got acquainted with **class war, economic inequality, the fight against financial exploitation, etc**.
- On **October 17, 1920**, the Communist Party of India was founded in **Tashkent**.

Role of Labour and Communist Class

- **Promotion of Unity:** Communists established the Workers' and Peasant Party (WPP) in 1928, inspired by the Peasants' and Workers' Party of Bengal, fostering unity among the labor class.
- **Advocacy for Workers' Rights:** Significant strikes, such as the 1928 strike movement totaling 31 million working days, including the Bombay textile strike involving around 150,000 workers for six months, highlighted the protest for workers' rights.
- **Formation of Unions:** The establishment of the in October 31, 1920 and the Indian Federation of Trade Unions (IFTU) marked major milestones in the workers' movement, providing organizational strength.
- **Contribution to Infrastructure:** Workers played a pivotal role in constructing railways and plantations, crucial for India's infrastructure development, subsequently aiding decentralization of the freedom movements.
- **Development of Mass Communication:** Leaders from the communist class initiated organizations and publications to raise awareness and promote welfare initiatives among workers.
  - Examples include Sasipada Banerjee's **"Working Men's Club"** and the Bengali-language publication **Bharat Shramjibi,** as well as N.M. Lokhandey's establishment of the **"Bombay Millhands' Association"** and publication of the Marathi periodical "Dinbandhu."

Conspiracy Case associated with Communist Class

Conspiracy Case	Reasons
Peshawar Conspiracy Case (1922–1927)	❖ Numerous Muslim Mujahirs joined **Roy's military academy** in Tashkent as a result of their displeasure with the British government's treatment of the Sultan of Turkey. ❖ They were apprehended on their way back to Peshawar, by the police.

Kanpur Bolshevik Conspiracy Case, 1924	❖ Leading communists **S. A. Dange, Nalini Gupta, Muzaffar Ahmad, and Shaukat Usmani** were the targets of a conspiracy case that claimed they established a revolutionary group with the intention of overturning British rule in India.
Lahore conspiracy case (1928-1929)	❖ To express opposition to the Public Safety Bill and Trade Disputes Bill, which both seek to restrict the civil liberties of people in general and workers in particular. ❖ On **April 8, 1929, Bhagat Singh and others** detonated a bomb within the Central Legislative Assembly. ❖ They faced trial in the conspiracy case which is known as the **Lahore conspiracy case**.
Meerut Conspiracy Case (1929-1933)	❖ Lord Irwin implemented draconian anti-communist actions by arresting **31 communists On 14th March 1929.** ❖ The Communists were accused of conspiring to use general strikes and armed uprisings against British India. They were prosecuted for this at Meerut.

Role of Princely States in Freedom Struggle

- The Indian struggle for independence from British colonial rule was inseparably linked to the freedom struggle in the Indian Princely States.
- The princes ruled over about 2/5th of the Indian subcontinent which had about 1/3rd the population of the British Empire in India.
- The British created an invisible wall between 'British India' and the '**Princely India**' by governing the latter indirectly through hereditary princes, who were supposedly fully autonomous, but for British 'paramountcy'.

Contribution of Princely States During the National Movement

- **Support for 1857 Revolt:** Princely states like Jhansi, Bareilly, and Jagdishpur participated in the 1857 revolt against British rule.
- **Political Mobilization**: Princely states were influenced by the national movement, with the emergence of political organizations such as Praja Mandals or State People Conferences.
- **Exemplary Leadership**: Some rulers, like those of Kolhapur state, actively championed modern ideas, public welfare, and the Indian national struggle.
- **Promotion of Democratic Reforms:** Ideas of democracy and civil liberties gradually permeated princely states, initially introduced by individual nationalists and revolutionaries seeking refuge there.
- **Integration with Quit India Movement (1942):** Residents of native states joined the Quit India movement upon Congress's call, formally aligning their struggle with the broader efforts in British India.

Various Ideological Strands of National Movement and Expansion of Social Base (UPSC Mains 2020)

- **Nationalist Revolution:**
  - The revolutionaries envisioned the State as it would be after achieving total independence.
  - They worked diligently to organise workers, students, and peasants to act as the catalyst for a widespread struggle with a particular goal.
  - Various activities, such as the train robbery in 1925, were used to raise money.
  - The youth were incited by Jogesh Chandra Chatterji, Sachin Sanyal, and Punjab Naujawan Sabha led by Bhagat Singh.
- **Gandhism**:
  - The mass base for the national struggle was expanded through Gandhism, Satyagraha, and the constructive program.
  - Congress under the leadership of Gandhiji was able to connect with India's rural populations because of the
  - **Struggle-Truce-Struggle formula**.
  - At the end, members of the marginalised society joined the Indian struggle.
  - **Ex:** The movement for temple entry, the welfare of Harijans, and farmer protests in Champaran and Kheda, Labour movements at Ahmedabad Mills etc.
- **Communism:**
  - The working class joined the movement with the explicit objective of achieving social equality.
  - **MN Roy** was the inspiration behind the ideology that drew in many Indian intellectuals, leading to the setting up of the Communist Party of India in 1925.

- They organised strikes in Bombay, TISCO, and southern railway after mobilising the working class.
- It elevated the fight for freedom to the global stage and won the support of international organisations.

- **Feminism:**
  - Gandhian methods have improved women's participation, and groups like the **All Indian Women's Association** had risen to the public forefront.
  - Civil disobedience and non-cooperation both featured active participation.
- **Rise of Socialism:**
  - Socialism began to gain ground after the 1920s and became a significant component of the National Movement.
  - It was amply reflected in the congressional resolution and the activism of well-known figures. JL Nehru, SC Bose, and others actively brought up issues affecting workers and peasants.
  - Workers' and peasants' parties were established throughout the nation, spreading Marxist and communist ideologies.
- **Communalism**:
  - Following the withdrawal of the non-cooperation movement, people experienced frustration and disillusionment.
  - During this time, Hindu Mahasabha and the League both experienced a resurgence. Nationalists were vilified as traitors as the fear psychology slowly took hold.
  - The congressmen's leaders failed to resist the pressure and adopted a communal or semi-communal attitude.
  - The two prominent organisations were **Muslim League and Hindu Mahasabha**.
- **Caste-based Movements:**
  - They emerged as a reaction to atrocities based on caste. Movements like the Justice Party in 1925 by Periyar, and the Vaikom Satyagraha by T.K. Madhavan and K. Kelappan 1924 raised awareness about the cruel caste-based practices that were being carried out.
  - They took part in round table discussions to voice their opinions and make demands for their rights.
- **Peasants:**
  - UP, the Rampa region of Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Ryotwari areas of Bombay and Madras witnessed peasant agitations for the revision of tenancy laws, lower rents, protection against eviction, and relief from debt. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (1928) led the Bardoli Satyagraha in Gujarat.
- **The Labour Class:**
  - Through the cotton mill workers' strike in Bombay (1919 and 1920), they took part in the non-cooperation movement.
  - Their activity increased after the Trade Union Act of 1926 became law. The British were dealt a serious blow by the labour strikes that took place during the civil disobedience movement, and the Indian Naval Revolt of 1946 benefited from their widespread participation.
- **Extremist Ideology:**
  - Extremists favoured strong mass demonstrations and the concept of Swaraj over the petitioning and prayer practices of moderates.
  - By founding political movements, they emphasized the need to mobilize people against foreign rule.

Foreign Participation in Freedom Movement

- The contributions of numerous foreigners to our struggle for freedom are immeasurable. The British took over India's political, economic, and social spheres following the Battle of Plassey. The indigenous traditions and customs declined with this colonization.
- The people of the land bravely fought against imperialism to gain their independence. Numerous foreigners also contributed significantly to India's freedom struggle throughout the span of 150 years of conflict.

Contribution of Foreigners to the Freedom Movement

- **Intellectual Awakening:** Foreigners helped people learn about the British's suppressive economic activities and other policies. They also motivated people to participate in the freedom movement.
  - It was further strengthened by factors like the rise of nationalism, the emergence of fresh economic forces, the expansion of education, the influence of contemporary Western culture, and a deeper understanding of the global community.
- **Nationalism and Democratic System:** The rising tide of nationalism and democracy also found expression in movements to democratise the social structures and worldview of the Indian people during the last decades of the nineteenth century.

- **Promoted scientific-based education:** The Wood's Dispatch of 1854 and subsequent policies emphasised scientific study and Western curricula. This led to the establishment of colleges based on European academic models, promoting a more modern and scientific approach to education in India.
- **Encouraged freedom of the Press:** Press were encouraged to promote government views, customs and cultures. However, some press activities were barred because of criticising government policies and mobilising people against them.
- **Fought for human rights:** The law of land concept along with values for human rights were promoted through the governance of the British in India.

Annie Besant and her Contribution

- She is one of the most well-known foreigners whose name appears in the struggle for freedom. She visited India in **1893** to promote the ideas of the Theosophical Society.
- In 1898, she founded the Central Hindu College in Benaresa (now Varanasi) intending to inspire pride in India's cultural heritage.
- Later, she was inspired by the ongoing struggle for freedom from British rule and progressively became an active participant.
- Establishing the in September 1916 was the most significant contribution to the movement for Indian independence.
- In 1917, Annie Besant was elected the President of the Indian National Congress (INC) Calcutta session, becoming the first woman to hold this position.
- Annie Besant and Lokmanya Bal Gangadhar Tilak played pivotal roles in advancing the independence movement, marking a significant turning point in India's prolonged struggle for freedom.
- **Organized in the manner of the Irish local government movement**, the crusade sought to bring Australia and Canada under the dominion of India. This played an important role in intensifying the freedom struggle.

Key Words

Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Swadeshi Movement, Home Rule League, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Unity and Integration, Jawaharlal Nehru, Purna Swaraj, Subhash Chandra Bose, Indian National Army, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, Dalit Rights, Constitution, Vinayak Damodar Savarkar, Hindutva, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Education Reform, Sarojini Naidu, Women's Empowerment.

	Previous Year Questions	Year
1.	Since the decade of the 1920s, the national movement acquired various ideological strands and thereby expanded its social base. Discuss.	2020
2.	Discuss the role of women in the freedom struggle, especially during the Gandhian phase.	2016